

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Feminism, Sex and Gender - Complete Topic Package

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Feminism, Sex and Gender

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1

Patriarchy, Feminism and the Central Political Question

2

Sex, Gender and the Social Construction of Hierarchy

3

Core Distinctions, Thinkers and Feminist Streams

4

Illustrations, Comparative Matrix and Trap Repair

5

Ownership Boundaries, Revision Spine and Source Discipline

6

Later Provenance and Marxist Feminism

7

Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family

8

Butler, Performativity and Intersectionality

9

Objection-Reply Chains and Cautious Indian Application

10

Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Feminism, Sex and Gender - Complete Topic Package	4
CURRENT-AFFAIRS ANCHOR - WOMEN IN PARLIAMENT 2025	4
DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT	4
BASIC LEARNING SESSION	4
SESSION 1 - Patriarchy, Feminism and the Central Political Question	4
SESSION 2 - Sex, Gender and the Social Construction of Hierarchy	5
SESSION 3 - Core Distinctions, Thinkers and Feminist Streams	6
SESSION 4 - Illustrations, Comparative Matrix and Trap Repair	6
SESSION 5 - Ownership Boundaries, Revision Spine and Source Discipline	7
SESSION 6 - Later Provenance and Marxist Feminism	8
SESSION 7 - Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family	8
SESSION 8 - Butler, Performativity and Intersectionality	9
SESSION 9 - Objection-Reply Chains and Cautious Indian Application	9
SESSION 10 - Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture	10
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	11
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	28
ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	31
OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER	36
1. One-screen advanced map	37
2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary	37
3. Direct-book argument reconstruction	37
4. Definitions and distinctions	37
5. Thinker-by-thinker positions	38
6. Competing perspectives	38
7. Internal debates and criticisms	38
8. Comparative matrix	38
9. Application without current-affairs dependence	39
10. UPSC answer-engine prompts	39

11. Cross-links and exclusions	39
12. Factual-risk checks	40
13. Sources, metadata and tags	40
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	40
ONE-PAGE CONCEPT GRID	41
CORE REVISION SPINE	41
HIGH-RISK TRAPS	42
ANSWER SPINE	42

Feminism, Sex and Gender - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Political Theory **Section:** Subject-wide Syllabus **Generation:** learner-v2:g6 **Ownership:** supplementary conceptual support; no synthetic GS or Optional PYQ ownership is created. **Source policy:** complete Basic owner first; optional Advanced depth only after practice.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS ANCHOR - WOMEN IN PARLIAMENT 2025

FACT: Fact (UN News, 6 March 2026): The IPU's *Women in parliament 2025* report found that chambers using legislated quotas averaged 31% women, compared with 23% in chambers without quotas. The same report warned that public intimidation disproportionately affects women MPs.

ANALYSIS: India-centric analytical use: Apply this only as comparative evidence in India's debate on women's political representation: formal entry rules can widen access, but party selection, political violence, care burdens and control over institutional power determine whether representation becomes substantive empowerment.

Source: <https://news.un.org/en/story/2026/03/1167092>

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

- **Learning goal:** move from an easy visual map through these ten stages: Patriarchy, Feminism and the Central Political Question; Sex, Gender and the Social Construction of Hierarchy; Core Distinctions, Thinkers and Feminist Streams; Illustrations, Comparative Matrix and Trap Repair; Ownership Boundaries, Revision Spine and Source Discipline; Later Provenance and Marxist Feminism; Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family; Butler, Performativity and Intersectionality; Objection-Reply Chains and Cautious Indian Application; Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture.
- **Syllabus boundary:** this package supplies Political Theory concepts and cross-applies only verified Philosophy Optional PYQs with their primary ownership preserved; constitutional, institutional and current-policy detail remains with its direct repository owner.
- **Answer-grabbing opening:** Feminism, Sex and Gender should be introduced through its controlling political question, not through biography or a dictionary list.
- **Transition rule:** define the concept -> name the thinker or evidence -> explain the political mechanism -> test the strongest objection -> qualify the verdict.
- **Conclusion rule:** answer the directive directly and state the remaining limit; do not end with an unqualified slogan.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

SESSION 1 - Patriarchy, Feminism and the Central Political Question

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS/Optional relevance:** GS-II (Polity & Governance) conceptual foundation; PSIR Optional Paper-1 background. **Core area:** Feminist critique of patriarchy through the distinction between biological sex and socially constructed gender. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.84-93. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged CURRENT:. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. **Companion:** Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md.

1. One-screen conceptual map

patriarchy

->

women's inferior status is social, not naturally justified

->

sex = biological difference

gender = cultural role/status construction

->

feminist critique

->

liberal feminism / radical feminism / socialist feminism

->

equal status + transformed social relations

- FACT: Gauba treats feminism as a protest against the inferior status assigned to women by patriarchy, not as a denial that biological differences exist. (PDF pp.84-86)

2. Why this topic matters

- FACT: The topic teaches how power can operate through family roles, labour division, culture and political exclusion, not only through law or property. (PDF pp.85-87)
- FACT: The sex-gender distinction is central for answering why inequality can be socially constructed even when biological difference is real. (PDF pp.84-86)
- FACT: The three streams of feminism provide a compact framework for PSIR and GS-II answers on equality, citizenship and justice. (PDF pp.88-90)

SESSION 2 - Sex, Gender and the Social Construction of Hierarchy

3. Essential definitions

- FACT: **Feminism**: concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: **Patriarchy**: literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: **Sex**: biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: **Gender**: culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men. (PDF pp.84-85)
- FACT: **Gender inequality**: a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change. (PDF p.86)
- FACT: **Feminist theory**: advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society. (PDF p.86)

4. Core argument / chapter spine

- FACT: Gauba starts by defining feminism as resistance to unjust female subordination produced by patriarchy. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: He then distinguishes sex from gender so that biological difference is separated from socially assigned inferiority. (PDF pp.84-86)
- FACT: Gender roles such as aggressiveness/dominance for men and submissiveness/expressiveness for women are treated as cultural instruments of social control. (PDF p.85)
- FACT: Gauba argues that biological differences do not justify inferior status for women; the main causes lie in social arrangements and cultural conditioning. (PDF pp.86-87)
- FACT: He ends by classifying feminism into liberal, radical and socialist streams. (PDF pp.88-90)

SESSION 3 - Core Distinctions, Thinkers and Feminist Streams

5. Essential distinctions

- FACT: **Sex vs gender**: sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social. (PDF pp.84-86)
- FACT: **Natural inequality vs conventional inequality**: Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category. (PDF p.86)
- FACT: **Legal equality vs substantive equality**: early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power. (PDF pp.88-91)
- FACT: **Equal treatment vs compensatory support**: Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures. (PDF pp.92-93)
- WRONG: **Biology justifies hierarchy**: Gauba explicitly rejects this. (PDF pp.86-87)

6. Thinkers and positions

- FACT: **Mary Wollstonecraft**: argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing. (PDF p.88)
- FACT: **J.S. Mill**: argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights. (PDF pp.84, 88)
- FACT: **Liberal feminism**: seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation. (PDF p.88)
- FACT: **Shulamith Firestone**: radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: **Kate Millett**: radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: **Sheila Rowbotham**: socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions. (PDF pp.89-90)

SESSION 4 - Illustrations, Comparative Matrix and Trap Repair

7. Illustrative examples

- FACT: Gauba's examples of girls being socialized toward obedience and boys toward assertiveness show how gender roles are culturally produced. (PDF p.87)
- FACT: The early rights agenda focused on education, property, divorce and suffrage because these exclusions had no necessary connection with female biology. (PDF pp.87-88)
- ANALYSIS: A safe classroom example is to contrast biological maternity with culturally assigned ideas that women must therefore remain outside public life.
- WRONG: Gauba's cited 1980 UN numerical claim and the follow-up line saying the condition remained unchanged should never be repeated as current fact; at most they are dated book-period illustrations. (PDF p.86)

8. Comparison table

Semantic table split - Stream

- **Stream**: Liberal feminism
- **Core claim**: FACT: Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life. (PDF p.88)
- **Main obstacle identified**: FACT: Formal legal, educational and professional barriers. (PDF pp.88-89)
- **Remedy emphasized**: FACT: Equal pay, representation, reform of discriminatory laws. (PDF p.88)
- **Stream**: Radical feminism
- **Core claim**: FACT: Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone. (PDF p.89)
- **Main obstacle identified**: FACT: Patriarchal sexual power and reproductive dependence. (PDF p.89)
- **Remedy emphasized**: FACT: Transform sex-power relations and dismantle domination. (PDF p.89)
- **Stream**: Socialist feminism

- **Core claim:** FACT: Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism. (PDF pp.89-90)
- **Main obstacle identified:** FACT: Wage labour, domestic labour and class exploitation together. (PDF pp.89-90)
- **Remedy emphasized:** FACT: Link women's liberation with broader anti-capitalist and anti-oppression struggles. (PDF p.90)

9. UPSC traps and corrections

- WRONG: **Sex and gender mean the same thing.** -> FACT: Gauba makes the distinction foundational: sex is biological, gender is cultural. (PDF pp.84-86)
- WRONG: **All feminism says women are biologically determined.** -> FACT: Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)
- WRONG: **If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no further issue.** -> FACT: Gauba shows later feminism asking about representation, social status and unequal participation in public power. (PDF pp.91-93)
- WRONG: **Old statistics in the book can be quoted as present reality.** -> WRONG: The 1980 UN figure and book-era representation data are historical and must not be presented as current fact. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)

SESSION 5 - Ownership Boundaries, Revision Spine and Source Discipline

10. Cross-links and boundaries

- FACT: Read the deeper companion at `Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md`.
- FACT: Use `Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md` for the ideology matrix and anti-caricature guidance on feminism.
- FACT: Use `Political-Theory/README.md` for the module map linking feminism to state, power, citizenship and justice.
- FACT: For cross-syllabus support, use `Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Gender-Discrimination.md`.
- FACT: For constitutional-equality application, move outward to `Polity/advanced/07_Fundamental-Rights.md`.
- FACT: Topic-map continuities especially matter with `Political-Theory/basic/13_Diverse-Perspectives-on-the-State.md` (feminist state), `Political-Theory/basic/15_Power-Authority-and-Legitimacy.md` (gendered power), `Political-Theory/basic/16_Citizenship-and-Its-Critiques.md` (feminist citizenship) and `Political-Theory/basic/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md` (feminist justice).

11. Revision capsule / answer spine

- FACT: Begin with feminism as protest against patriarchy. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: Define sex and gender separately and sharply. (PDF pp.84-86)
- FACT: Use Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality distinction to show why gender hierarchy is alterable. (PDF p.86)
- FACT: Note that biological differences do not justify inferior status. (PDF pp.86-87)
- FACT: Classify feminism into liberal, radical and socialist streams with one thinker each. (PDF pp.88-90)
- FACT: End by warning against using Gauba's dated numerical claims as present-day evidence. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)

12. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.84-93.
- FACT: Key anchors: feminism, patriarchy, sex-gender distinction (PDF pp.84-86); socialization and inequality (PDF pp.86-87); Wollstonecraft, Mill and three streams of feminism (PDF pp.88-90).
- ANALYSIS: Tags: `#PoliticalTheory #Feminism #Patriarchy #SexAndGender #LiberalFeminism #RadicalFeminism #SocialistFeminism`.

SESSION 6 - Later Provenance and Marxist Feminism

13. Provenance beyond Gauba: sex/gender, standpoint and later feminist theory (extension - use with caution)

- ANALYSIS: Gauba's chapter grounds the sex/gender distinction and the liberal/radical/socialist typology; it does **not** itself discuss Simone de Beauvoir, Gayle Rubin, Ann Oakley, Carole Pateman, Susan Moller Okin, Judith Butler or Kimberlé Crenshaw. Everything below is a standard PSIR/political-theory extension used by examiners beyond this specific book, flagged ANALYSIS: throughout, and is not tied to a page number in the primary source.
- ANALYSIS: **Simone de Beauvoir** (*The Second Sex*, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.
- ANALYSIS: **Ann Oakley** (*Sex, Gender and Society*, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
- ANALYSIS: **Gayle Rubin** ("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains *how* sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.
- ANALYSIS: Caveat: cite these three names as standard provenance for the sex/gender distinction, but do not present a single, uncontested "origin story" as settled fact - the distinction has multiple co-formulators and was consolidated gradually; avoid taxonomic overclaim.

Marxist feminism, reconstructed separately from socialist feminism

- ANALYSIS: This basic file (like Gauba) uses "socialist feminism" as the umbrella term (Rowbotham) for the patriarchy-plus-capitalism synthesis. Marxist feminism is a related but analytically prior strand a strong answer should distinguish:
- **Claim:** women's oppression is generated principally by the capitalist mode of production, especially unpaid domestic/reproductive labour that reproduces the workforce free of charge.
- **Evidence:** the 1970s "domestic labour debate" treated housework as unwaged labour-power reproduction necessary for capital accumulation.
- **Significance:** relocates the "private" household inside political economy, making family labour a class question, not only a cultural one.
- **Limit:** a pure class-reduction cannot explain patriarchal violence or control of sexuality that predates and outlasts capitalism - which is exactly why Rowbotham's socialist-feminist synthesis treats patriarchy and capitalism as two distinct, mutually reinforcing systems rather than one reducible to the other.
- ANALYSIS: Exam use: if a question specifically says "Marxist feminism," lead with the domestic-labour/social-reproduction claim; if it says "socialist feminism," lead with Rowbotham's dual-systems synthesis; the two labels overlap but are not simple synonyms.

SESSION 7 - Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family

Carole Pateman and Susan Moller Okin: feminist critique of contract and justice theory

- ANALYSIS: **Carole Pateman** (*The Sexual Contract*, 1988): **Claim** - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination. **Evidence** - contract narratives are silent on the marriage contract and domestic subordination that make male civic equality possible. **Significance** - reframes liberal equality as resting on an unexamined patriarchal foundation. **Limit** - the thesis reconstructs contract theory's silences; it is an interpretive lens, not a documented historical event, and should not be used as a factual claim about any real contract being signed.

- ANALYSIS: **Susan Moller Okin** (*Justice, Gender, and the Family*, 1989): **Claim** - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine. **Evidence** - unequal domestic burden restricts women's access to the "primary goods" (time, income, position) public justice is meant to distribute. **Significance** - extends justice from state/market into the household. **Limit** - risks over-extending justice into every private relationship, which is why most syntheses still preserve some sphere of family autonomy alongside gender-just background conditions.

SESSION 8 - Butler, Performativity and Intersectionality

Judith Butler and performativity (careful use)

- ANALYSIS: **Judith Butler** (*Gender Trouble*, 1990): gender is not a cultural coating on a stable biological sex but *performative* - produced through repeated, stylised acts (speech, gesture, dress, behaviour) that create the appearance of a natural gendered self; on this account even "sex" is partly constituted through gendered discourse, not a wholly pre-discursive bedrock.
- ANALYSIS: Use with care: (a) do not present this as Gauba's own position - it is a later, more radical move than the textbook sex/gender split; (b) do not claim Butler denies bodies exist - the claim is about how the *meaning and categorisation* of bodies is produced; (c) pair it immediately with the objection/reply below so the answer shows awareness of debate rather than treating performativity as settled.

Intersectionality (Kimberlé Crenshaw)

- ANALYSIS: **Kimberlé Crenshaw** ("Demarginalizing the Intersection of Race and Sex", 1989): **Claim** - treating race and sex discrimination as separate, additive categories fails women who face a distinct, compounded disadvantage at their intersection. **Evidence** - Crenshaw's illustration showed Black women's employment-discrimination claims falling through the gap between a race-discrimination template and a sex-discrimination template, each implicitly modelled on a different unmarked group. **Significance** - forces liberal/radical/socialist/Marxist feminism to ask *which* women a given claim describes, correcting an unstated universalism. **Limit** - an intersectional list can become analytically unwieldy without a clear political question in view; it supplements, but should not replace, the structural claims of the four schools above.

SESSION 9 - Objection-Reply Chains and Cautious Indian Application

14. Two objection-reply chains (mandatory doctrinal debate)

1. **Objection:** if gender is entirely performative/socially constructed (Butler), feminism loses a stable category of "woman" around which to organise and to claim rights.

Reply: many feminist theorists respond that political claims can be built on provisionally, strategically stabilised categories even while accepting the category is historically constructed ("strategic essentialism"); legal sex-discrimination categories function pragmatically regardless of deeper philosophical instability. ANALYSIS: Present as a live, contested debate - not a settled result.

2. **Objection:** radical feminism's emphasis on patriarchy as the primary, near-universal structure of oppression risks treating "women" as one undifferentiated class, erasing differences of race, class and caste among women.

Reply: Crenshaw's intersectionality and Marxist/socialist feminism's attention to class supply the corrective - oppression is compounded and differently configured across axes, producing a more accurate map of *whose* subordination is being explained. ANALYSIS: This reply strengthens rather than replaces the original radical-feminist insight that sexual/reproductive domination is analytically distinct from class or race domination.

15. Cautious Indian application

- ANALYSIS: **Savitribai Phule** is widely associated, with Jyotirao Phule, with pioneering girls' education in nineteenth-century Maharashtra - use as an illustration of an early, home-grown challenge to gendered exclusion from education; do not attach specific unverified school-opening dates or numbers unless independently confirmed. Keep the claim at "early advocate of women's education against caste-and-gender exclusion."
- ANALYSIS: **B. R. Ambedkar** is widely associated with linking women's legal and social equality to the wider project of social democracy, including reform of Hindu personal law - treat this as a general, well-known orientation

of his thought rather than citing precise bill provisions, sections or dates, since exact legislative detail sits outside this file's verified source base.

- ANALYSIS: The broader Indian women's movement (legal-reform and political-representation campaigns from the 1970s onward) is a standard illustrative anchor for "formal legal equality is not the end of the feminist question" - use it as a *type* of example (movement-led legal reform), not with specific statute names, years or case citations unless separately verified through a dedicated Polity/legal source.
- ANALYSIS: Discipline: this file owns the *conceptual* application (patriarchy, sex/gender, representation gap); it does not own specific constitutional articles, acts or case law - route those to the Polity module (as already flagged in section 10) rather than asserting legal facts here.

SESSION 10 - Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

16. Executable answer architecture (10/15/20 marks)

Directive decoding

- "Discuss/Examine feminism as a critique of patriarchy" -> needs both diagnosis (what patriarchy is, how gender is produced) and the feminist reply; do not describe patriarchy without the feminist response.
- "Distinguish sex and gender" -> definitional/analytical directive: give the distinction plus why it matters, not two one-line definitions.
- "Critically examine feminist perspectives on X" -> requires thesis + at least two schools compared + at least one objection/reply, ending in a reasoned verdict, not a neutral list.

10-mark architecture (~150 words)

1. **Thesis (1-2 lines):** feminism protests patriarchal subordination via the sex/gender distinction; formal legal equality alone is insufficient.
2. **Body:** sex vs gender (claim->evidence->significance) + one stream (liberal/radical/socialist/Marxist) with its core mechanism.
3. **One qualifier/limit.**
4. **One-line conclusion** tied to the thesis.

15-mark architecture (~200-250 words)

1. Thesis with directive-specific framing.
2. Doctrine reconstruction: sex/gender distinction (de Beauvoir/Oakley/Rubin, ANALYSIS:-flagged) -> patriarchy as a political, not merely domestic, category.
3. Compare 2-3 streams (liberal/radical/socialist-Marxist) using claim->evidence->significance->limit each.
4. One objection-reply chain.
5. One cautious Indian illustration.
6. Reasoned conclusion.

20-mark architecture (~250-300 words)

1. Thesis + explicit directive decoding.
2. Full doctrine reconstruction: patriarchy -> sex/gender (de Beauvoir/Oakley/Rubin) -> why biology does not justify hierarchy (Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality, per Gauba).
3. All streams (liberal, radical, socialist, Marxist) each with claim->evidence->significance->limit.
4. Pateman/Okin extension where the question concerns citizenship, justice or the family.
5. Two objection-reply chains (performativity vs category stability; single-axis vs intersectionality).
6. Cautious Indian application, correctly hedged, without owning legal specifics.
7. Balanced, graded conclusion noting both formal-equality achievement and the unfinished substantive-equality agenda.

Quotation/proposition method

- Prefer paraphrased, named propositions over unverified verbatim quotations, e.g. "*de Beauvoir's proposition that womanhood is socially produced rather than born*" rather than a quoted sentence, unless the quotation is independently confirmed. This credits the correct thinker and claim while avoiding misquotation risk.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Feminism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
- B. advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- C. argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- D. socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Feminism** with **concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex**.

- A. Liberal feminism
- B. Feminism
- C. Gayle Rubin
- D. Sex

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex** with **Feminism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Patriarchy**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.
- B. argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.
- C. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- D. Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Patriarchy** with **literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life**.

- A. Radical feminism
- B. Carole Pateman
- C. Gender
- D. Patriarchy

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life** with **Patriarchy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Sex**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- B. Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.
- C. seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- D. Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sex** with **biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.**

- A. Socialist feminism
- B. Sex
- C. Susan Moller Okin
- D. Gender inequality

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.** with **Sex**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Gender**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
- B. radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.
- C. culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- D. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gender** with **culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.**

- A. Simone de Beauvoir
- B. Feminism
- C. Feminist theory
- D. Gender

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.** with **Gender**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Gender inequality**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
- B. Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.
- C. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- D. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gender inequality** with **a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change**.

- A. Ann Oakley
- B. Gender inequality
- C. Patriarchy
- D. Sex vs gender

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change**, with **Gender inequality**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Feminist theory**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- B. (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
- C. advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- D. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Feminist theory** with **advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.**

- A. Gayle Rubin
- B. Sex
- C. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality
- D. Feminist theory

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.** with **Feminist theory.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Sex vs gender**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.
- B. argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.
- C. Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.
- D. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sex vs gender** with **sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.**

- A. Carole Pateman
- B. Sex vs gender
- C. Gender
- D. Legal equality vs substantive equality

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.** with **Sex vs gender.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Natural inequality vs conventional inequality**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- B. Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.
- C. Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.
- D. (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Natural inequality vs conventional inequality** with **Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category**.

- A. Susan Moller Okin
- B. Gender inequality
- C. Equal treatment vs compensatory support
- D. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category** with **Natural inequality vs conventional inequality**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Legal equality vs substantive equality**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
- B. radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.
- C. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.
- D. (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Legal equality vs substantive equality** with **early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.**

- A. Feminism
- B. Legal equality vs substantive equality
- C. Feminist theory
- D. Mary Wollstonecraft

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.** with **Legal equality vs substantive equality.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Equal treatment vs compensatory support**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- B. (The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.
- C. Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.
- D. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Equal treatment vs compensatory support** with **Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.**

- A. Patriarchy
- B. Sex vs gender
- C. J.S. Mill
- D. Equal treatment vs compensatory support

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.** with **Equal treatment vs compensatory support.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Mary Wollstonecraft**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- B. socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.
- C. (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
- D. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mary Wollstonecraft** with **argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.**

- A. Sex
- B. Mary Wollstonecraft
- C. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality
- D. Liberal feminism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.** with **Mary Wollstonecraft.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **J.S. Mill**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.
- B. ("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.
- C. argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.
- D. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **J.S. Mill** with **argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights**.

- A. Gender
- B. Legal equality vs substantive equality
- C. Shulamith Firestone
- D. J.S. Mill

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights** with **J.S. Mill**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Liberal feminism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- B. Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.
- C. (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.
- D. culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberal feminism** with **seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.**

- A. Gender inequality
- B. Liberal feminism
- C. Equal treatment vs compensatory support
- D. Kate Millett

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.** with **Liberal feminism.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Shulamith Firestone**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.
- B. (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.
- C. radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.
- D. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Shulamith Firestone** with **radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.**

- A. Feminist theory
- B. Mary Wollstonecraft
- C. Sheila Rowbotham
- D. Shulamith Firestone

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.** with **Shulamith Firestone.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Kate Millett**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- B. (The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.
- C. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
- D. advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Kate Millett** with **radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology**.

- A. Sex vs gender
- B. Kate Millett
- C. J.S. Mill
- D. Liberal feminism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology** with **Kate Millett**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Sheila Rowbotham**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
- B. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- C. socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.
- D. sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sheila Rowbotham** with **socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.**

- A. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality
- B. Liberal feminism
- C. Radical feminism
- D. Sheila Rowbotham

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.** with **Sheila Rowbotham**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Liberal feminism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.
- B. ("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.
- C. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- D. Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberal feminism** with **Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.**

- A. Legal equality vs substantive equality
- B. Liberal feminism
- C. Shulamith Firestone
- D. Socialist feminism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.** with **Liberal feminism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Radical feminism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.
- B. culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- C. Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.
- D. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Radical feminism** with **Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone**.

- A. Equal treatment vs compensatory support
- B. Kate Millett
- C. Simone de Beauvoir
- D. Radical feminism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone** with **Radical feminism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Socialist feminism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.
- B. (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.
- C. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
- D. Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Socialist feminism** with **Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.**

- A. Mary Wollstonecraft
- B. Socialist feminism
- C. Sheila Rowbotham
- D. Ann Oakley

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.** with **Socialist feminism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Simone de Beauvoir**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
- B. advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- C. (The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.
- D. argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Simone de Beauvoir** with **(The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **(The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.**

- A. J.S. Mill
- B. Liberal feminism
- C. Gayle Rubin
- D. Simone de Beauvoir

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **(The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.** with **Simone de Beauvoir**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Ann Oakley**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
- B. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- C. sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.
- D. argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ann Oakley** with **(Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **(Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology**.

- A. Liberal feminism
- B. Ann Oakley
- C. Radical feminism
- D. Carole Pateman

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **(Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology** with **Ann Oakley**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Gayle Rubin**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- B. Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.
- C. ("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.
- D. seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gayle Rubin** with **("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: ("**The Traffic in Women**", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "**sex/gender system**" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.

- A. Shulamith Firestone
- B. Socialist feminism
- C. Susan Moller Okin
- D. Gayle Rubin

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs ("**The Traffic in Women**", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "**sex/gender system**" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise. with **Gayle Rubin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Carole Pateman**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.
- B. culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- C. early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
- D. radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Carole Pateman** with (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **(The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.**

- A. Kate Millett
- B. Carole Pateman
- C. Simone de Beauvoir
- D. Feminism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **(The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.** with **Carole Pateman**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Susan Moller Okin**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
- B. Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.
- C. (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.
- D. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Susan Moller Okin** with **(Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **(Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.**

- A. Sheila Rowbotham
- B. Ann Oakley
- C. Patriarchy
- D. Susan Moller Okin

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **(Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.** with **Susan Moller Okin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Cross-application ownership note: These are verified Philosophy Optional questions whose primary owner is Gender Discrimination. They are not re-routed to Political Theory; they are included because this topic provides a directly usable supporting framework.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Gender Discrimination.

PYQ 1 - 2018 · 4(c) (15 marks)

Question: Is feminism an ideology for empowerment or for equality ? Discuss.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Is:** answer the proposition immediately, specify the conditions or degree, test the counter-position and return to a qualified yes/no verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Thesis / opening: Feminism is often presented as pursuing either 'equality' (sameness of treatment) or 'empowerment' (capacity to exercise choice), but the equality typology shows these are not rival goals so much as different levels of the same project.

Model answer structure:

- Formal equality demands the removal of explicit differential rules; substantive equality goes further, licensing affirmative measures to correct unequal starting points; relational equality asks whether social relationships remain hierarchical regardless of formal rules. Empowerment, on Kabeer's tripartite model, requires resources, agency, and achievements -- it is the process by which formal or substantive equality is actually converted into lived capacity. On this reading, equality supplies the normative target and empowerment supplies the causal mechanism by which that target is reached.
- Objection: treating equality and empowerment as compatible obscures a real tension -- substantive-equality measures (affirmative action) can be attacked as unearned 'empowerment' that violates formal equality for others (the reverse-discrimination objection). Reply: the objection conflates formal and substantive equality; substantive equality does not violate the requirement of equal moral worth, it corrects an unequal starting point so that formal equality's promise can be genuinely realised.

Conclusion: Feminism is best read as an ideology for substantive equality achieved through empowerment -- the two are sequentially linked rather than competing final ends.

Why this earns marks: It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Gender Discrimination.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Is feminism an ideology for empowerment or for equality ? Discuss." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

PYQ 2 - 2022 · 3(b) (15 marks)

Question: Discuss gender as a cultural category as opposed to sex as a biological category.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Discuss**: cover the principal dimensions, connect named evidence to each claim, include the strongest counter-position and conclude directly. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Thesis / opening: Sex names a biological fact; gender names the socially constructed meaning attached to that fact, a distinction Beauvoir opens and Judith Butler's account of performativity deepens into a full cultural-category theory.

Model answer structure:

- Butler's Gender Trouble argues gender is constituted through performative repetition of stylised acts within a regulatory, discursive frame -- there is no gendered substance prior to or behind the repeated acts. This treats gender as thoroughly cultural: produced, disciplined, and reproduced through social practice, in contrast to sex, which denotes a biological given. The cultural-category reading explains variation across societies and time in what counts as masculine or feminine, which a purely biological account cannot.
- Objection (essentialism objection): without any stable pre-discursive sex or subject, feminism risks losing the category 'woman' in whose name it claims to act, undermining political solidarity. Reply: Butler allows a provisional, strategic use of 'woman' as a shared discursive position for political purposes, which does not require metaphysical essence, only a shared position worth contesting.

Conclusion: Gender is best treated as a cultural category, continuously produced through social practice, standing in contrast to (but not simply derived from) sex as a biological category.

Why this earns marks: It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Gender Discrimination.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Discuss gender as a cultural category as opposed to sex as a biological category." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

PYQ 3 - 2025 · 1(b) (10 marks)

Question: How does gender as a social construct affect individuals' opportunities, rights, and access to resources? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **How**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Thesis / opening: Gender, as a social rather than biological construct in Beauvoir's and Butler's sense, shapes the opportunities, rights, and resource access individuals are granted or denied well before any individual merit is considered.

Model answer structure:

- Once woman is constructed as Other (Beauvoir) and gender is reproduced through performative repetition (Butler), that constructed meaning is used to justify differential access: to education and employment (opportunity), to inheritance and representation (rights, per Sessions 5 and 7), and to land, credit, and property (resources, per Session 5's five-level analysis). Because the construction is social rather than natural, the resulting inequality is a matter of formal versus substantive equality (Session 3) rather than an unavoidable fact of nature.
- Objection: if gender is 'only' a construct, one could argue the resulting disadvantage is not 'real' in the way material biological constraint is real, understating the urgency of reform. Reply: constructed does not mean unreal or trivial -- socially constructed disadvantage has entirely real material consequences (land denial, foeticide, exclusion from representation), and being constructed is precisely what makes it remediable through social and legal change.

Conclusion: Gender as a social construct systematically structures unequal opportunity, rights, and resource access; its constructed status is a reason for urgency and remediability, not for dismissal.

Why this earns marks: It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "How does gender as a social construct affect individuals' opportunities, rights, and access to resources? Critically discuss." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish sex from gender and explain why the distinction matters politically. Answer in about 150 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Distinguish**: define both sides, compare them on common axes, identify the decisive difference and close with its significance. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Sex ordinarily refers to bodily and reproductive characteristics, whereas gender refers to the socially organised roles, expectations and status attached to perceived sex.

Core analysis: The distinction explains how a biological difference becomes a political hierarchy. Gauba treats masculinity and femininity as culturally coded patterns rather than necessary consequences of anatomy. Rousseau's natural-conventional distinction then clarifies the normative point: even where bodily differences are real, unequal education, work, authority and citizenship are conventional arrangements. Feminism can therefore challenge the inference from difference to inferiority. Beauvoir, Oakley and Rubin deepen the account by showing womanhood as social becoming and by explaining the institutions through which sex is converted into gendered obligation.

Critical evaluation: The distinction should not be made absolute. Butler argues that even the social interpretation and classification of bodies are gendered. This complication revises the framework without restoring biological destiny.

Conclusion: The distinction is politically decisive because bodily difference does not entail social rank: once gender hierarchy is recognised as historically produced, it becomes open to criticism, collective action and institutional transformation.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Distinguish sex from gender and explain why the distinction matters politically." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why is patriarchy a political category rather than merely a description of family authority? Answer in about 150 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Why**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Patriarchy literally evokes rule of the father, but feminist theory uses it for a wider structure of male domination extending beyond the household.

Core analysis: It is political because it distributes power and life chances. Gendered socialisation shapes aspirations; the division of paid and unpaid labour shapes economic dependence; control over sexuality and reproduction shapes bodily autonomy; and unequal representation shapes public decision-making. Kate Millett therefore interprets relations between the sexes as power relations supported by ideology and authority. Once household arrangements affect education, income, mobility, voice and citizenship, the public-private boundary cannot remove them from political evaluation. Pateman and Okin further show how apparently equal public institutions may rely on unequal domestic labour and authority.

Critical evaluation: Not every family difference is domination, and the concept can become overgeneralised. It is strongest when tied to identifiable mechanisms of unequal power rather than used as a slogan for every disadvantage.

Conclusion: Patriarchy is political because it organises power, labour, status and voice across household and public institutions; feminist theory therefore makes domination within the so-called private sphere answerable to standards of freedom and justice.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Why is patriarchy a political category rather than merely a description of family authority?" - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Compare liberal, radical, Marxist and socialist feminism as explanations of women's subordination. Answer in about 200 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **the stated directive**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Feminist schools share opposition to unjust gender hierarchy but disagree over its principal mechanism and the institutional depth of the remedy.

Core analysis: Liberal feminism locates the problem in discriminatory laws, blocked education, unequal opportunity and weak representation; Wollstonecraft and Mill support rights-based reform. Radical feminism treats patriarchal control of sexuality, reproduction and cultural meaning as a primary system not reducible to class; Millett and Firestone illustrate different versions. Marxist feminism explains how capitalism benefits from women's paid and unpaid reproductive labour. Socialist feminism, associated here with Rowbotham, rejects class reduction and analyses capitalism and patriarchy as distinct but mutually reinforcing structures.

Further development: The remedies follow from the diagnoses. Liberal feminism reforms law, education and representation; radical feminism transforms sexual power and patriarchal culture; Marxist feminism reorganises production and social reproduction; socialist feminism combines economic transformation with autonomous struggle against patriarchy. Intersectionality supplies a further test by asking whether class, caste, race and other structures alter the operation of gender. This does not create a fifth all-purpose answer; it prevents each existing school from treating its most visible constituency as universal. A strong synthesis therefore preserves causal plurality while demanding a clear account of which institution is being changed.

Critical evaluation: Each approach risks reductionism: liberalism may stop at formal access, radicalism may universalise one female experience, Marxism may absorb gender into class, and socialist feminism may become causally diffuse. Comparison should identify what each explains best.

Conclusion: The four approaches are best treated as complementary but contestable lenses: rights, sexual power, capitalist reproduction and interacting systems each reveal a distinct mechanism that no single-axis explanation exhausts.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Compare liberal, radical, Marxist and socialist feminism as explanations of women's subordination." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine Judith Butler's account of gender performativity and the category problem it creates for feminism. Answer in about 200 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Critically examine**: reconstruct the position accurately, test its strongest objection and reply, then give a graded verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Judith Butler radicalises the sex-gender debate by treating gender as performative: repeated, socially compelled acts produce the appearance of a natural identity.

Core analysis: Performativity does not mean a freely chosen theatrical performance, nor does it deny bodies. It argues that speech, dress, gesture and institutional classification repeatedly constitute intelligible gendered subjects. Because the norm requires repetition, failed or subversive repetition can disclose its contingency. This helps feminism explain why hierarchy survives without a single commanding patriarch and why apparently personal conduct is politically regulated.

Further development: Butler also challenges the standard textbook picture in which a stable biological sex merely receives a cultural gender. The categories through which bodies are recognised are themselves organised by discourse and power. Critics reply that this approach may understate material constraints, reproductive embodiment and durable institutions. Butler's contribution remains strongest as an account of naturalisation: norms appear inevitable because repetition conceals their history. Political feminism can accept this insight while retaining empirically usable categories for law and mobilisation. The category must function as a revisable coalition rather than an essence that predetermines all members.

Critical evaluation: The category problem is serious: if 'woman' is wholly an unstable effect of discourse, the subject of anti-discrimination claims appears to dissolve. A common reply is strategic or provisional stabilisation-groups may use a category for a specific political purpose without declaring it natural or permanent. Yet temporary categories can harden and exclude those who fit badly.

Conclusion: Butler strengthens feminism by exposing the repeated practices that naturalise gender, but political action still requires provisional categories whose strategic use must remain open to internal criticism and revision.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Critically examine Judith Butler's account of gender performativity and the category problem it creates for feminism." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate the feminist critique of the public-private divide with reference to Carole Pateman and Susan Moller Okin. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Evaluate**: reconstruct the position accurately, test its strongest objection and reply, then give a graded verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 250 words: thesis, five or six developed dimensions, a named comparison, the strongest objection/reply and a graded conclusion. Cut biography and repeated definitions before cutting evidence, qualification or verdict. **Model solution**

Introduction: Feminist political theory argues that public freedom is incomplete when the household and intimate sphere are treated as naturally private and exempt from justice.

Core analysis: Carole Pateman's *The Sexual Contract* reconstructs classical contract theory as resting on an unspoken structure of male access to women's bodies and labour. The thesis is interpretive, not a claim that an actual historical contract was signed. Susan Moller Okin argues that theories such as Rawls's insufficiently examine the family as a site where gendered labour produces unequal time, income and opportunity. The apparently neutral citizen entering public life may therefore carry resources made possible by another person's unpaid care and dependence.

Further development: The critique also changes the meaning of citizenship. If one citizen's public participation depends on another's unequal domestic burden, formally identical rights conceal unequal effective freedom. Indian application should remain conceptual: women's education, property control, political representation and care work illustrate the conversion problem without importing unverified statistics or legal detail. Critics may defend family autonomy and warn against bureaucratic intrusion. The feminist reply is that autonomy itself requires non-domination, material exit and shared responsibility. Public institutions need not prescribe one family form, but they cannot treat coercive dependency as beyond justice merely because it occurs at home.

Critical evaluation: The critique rightly exposes how law, markets and citizenship depend on background relations. However, making every intimate decision directly administrable by the state threatens privacy and plural association. The answer is not abolition of privacy, but justice-sensitive background conditions: freedom from violence, fair care burdens, economic security and genuine exit.

Conclusion: Pateman and Okin show that public equality cannot rest on unexamined private subordination; a defensible settlement protects personal intimacy while subjecting coercive dependency and gendered background conditions to justice.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Evaluate the feminist critique of the public-private divide with reference to Carole Pateman and Susan Moller Okin." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 20 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Is feminism best understood as a project of equality, empowerment or social transformation? Discuss. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Is**: answer the proposition immediately, specify the conditions or degree, test the counter-position and return to a qualified yes/no verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 250 words: thesis, five or six developed dimensions, a named comparison, the strongest objection/reply and a graded conclusion. Cut biography and repeated definitions before cutting evidence, qualification or verdict. **Model solution**

Introduction: Equality, empowerment and social transformation name different levels of the feminist project rather than mutually exclusive goals.

Core analysis: Equality attacks unjust status distinctions through rights, education, property, work and representation. Empowerment asks whether women possess the resources, capabilities, voice and control needed to use formal rights. Transformation goes further by changing gendered socialisation, care arrangements, labour markets, family authority and cultural norms that reproduce dependence. Liberal feminism foregrounds equal access; radical feminism exposes sexual and reproductive power; Marxist and socialist feminism connect household labour with political economy; intersectionality asks which women benefit or remain marginalised.

Further development: The historical sequence illustrates the integration. Early rights feminism removed formal exclusions; later movements showed that suffrage and legal personality did not automatically redistribute authority, labour or recognition. Pateman and Okin relocate justice within the background institutions of contract and family. Butler reveals the repeated norms through which identities are naturalised, while Crenshaw's intersectionality tests whether a universal category conceals differentiated disadvantage. A current comparative anchor also supports the distinction: the 2026 UN summary of the IPU's 2025 report found higher average women's representation in chambers with legislated quotas, but representation alone does not establish equal influence or freedom from intimidation. Institutional access must therefore be evaluated through substantive power.

Critical evaluation: The concepts can conflict. Equal treatment may ignore pregnancy or unequal care burdens, while protective differentiation may entrench stereotypes. Empowerment can be reduced to individual success without structural change, and transformation can become paternalistic if imposed without women's agency. A defensible feminism therefore joins equal status, substantive capability and democratic transformation.

Conclusion: Feminism is most adequately understood as an integrated project: equality supplies status and rights, empowerment supplies effective agency, and social transformation removes the institutions and norms that repeatedly reproduce subordination.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Is feminism best understood as a project of equality, empowerment or social transformation? Discuss." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 20 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS/Optional relevance:** GS-II (Polity & Governance) conceptual foundation; PSIR Optional Paper-1 background. **Core area:** From the sex-gender distinction to competing feminist explanations of subordination, power and equality. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.84-93. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged **CURRENT**:. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. *Companion:* Political-Theory/basic/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md.

1. One-screen advanced map

patriarchy

->

sex (biology) != gender (social meaning)

->

women's inequality is culturally organized

->

early equal-rights feminism

-> liberal feminism

-> radical feminism

-> socialist feminism

->

citizenship, representation and justice questions

- ANALYSIS: The advanced move is from "women lack rights" to "social power is gender-coded even after formal rights are granted."

2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary

- FACT: This file remains theory-centred: patriarchy, sex/gender, streams of feminism and the status of women in public life. (PDF pp.84-93)
- FACT: Gauba includes many numerical and representational illustrations from the late twentieth century; they must be treated as historical/book-period material rather than current data. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)
- ANALYSIS: The point here is not current gender-data reporting, but the conceptual tools needed to analyse gendered inequality.

3. Direct-book argument reconstruction

- FACT: Step 1: feminism is introduced as protest against the inferior status of women created by patriarchy. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: Step 2: Gauba separates sex from gender so that biological difference is not confused with social hierarchy. (PDF pp.84-86)
- FACT: Step 3: masculinity and femininity are shown as culturally coded patterns that reproduce male dominance. (PDF p.85)
- FACT: Step 4: using Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality distinction, Gauba shows gender inequality to be socially alterable. (PDF p.86)
- FACT: Step 5: early feminism is reconstructed through Wollstonecraft and Mill as a demand for rights, education, property and civic equality. (PDF p.88)
- FACT: Step 6: contemporary feminism is classified into liberal, radical and socialist strands. (PDF pp.88-90)
- FACT: Step 7: Gauba then extends the issue from rights to representation, citizenship and gender justice. (PDF pp.90-93)

4. Definitions and distinctions

- FACT: **Patriarchy**: male domination extending from household authority into labour market and public life. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: **Sex**: biological division of humans into male and female. (PDF pp.84-85)
- FACT: **Gender**: the cultural organization of expectations, roles and status attached to sex. (PDF pp.84-85)
- FACT: **Masculinity / femininity**: socially coded personality-traits and behaviours that naturalize domination/submission. (PDF p.85)
- FACT: **Natural inequality / conventional inequality**: Rousseau's distinction used by Gauba to show that gender hierarchy belongs largely to the second category. (PDF p.86)
- FACT: **Equal rights view vs compensatory-equality view**: one stresses same laws, the other supports differentiated protections and representation-enhancing measures. (PDF pp.92-93)

5. Thinker-by-thinker positions

- FACT: **Mary Wollstonecraft**: rejects female inferiority and insists that women, as rational beings, deserve education, property and civic rights. (PDF p.88)
- FACT: **J.S. Mill**: argues that women are not less talented than men and should enjoy full legal and political equality. (PDF pp.84, 88)
- FACT: **Shulamith Firestone**: radical feminist who treats reproductive biology as the ultimate historical basis of female subordination and sees technology as enabling escape from that dependence. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: **Kate Millett**: reads male-female relations as political power relations sustained by ideology, authority and economic force. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: **Sheila Rowbotham**: socialist feminist who ties women's liberation to anti-capitalist struggle and the recovery of women's hidden history. (PDF pp.89-90)
- ANALYSIS: Together these thinkers move the debate from rights-based equality, to patriarchy as power, to patriarchy-plus-capitalism as a combined structure.

6. Competing perspectives

- FACT: **Liberal feminism**: focuses on equal opportunity and the removal of formal discrimination. (PDF p.88)
- FACT: **Radical feminism**: insists that women's oppression is primary and cannot be dissolved into race or class alone. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: **Socialist feminism**: combines patriarchal analysis with Marxist class analysis. (PDF pp.89-90)
- ANALYSIS: Liberal feminism asks whether barriers are open; radical feminism asks who holds power over bodies and sexuality; socialist feminism asks how capitalism and patriarchy reinforce each other.
- ANALYSIS: For UPSC, the richest contrast is between formal equality, sexual power and structural political economy.

7. Internal debates and criticisms

- FACT: Gauba's own presentation shows that formal rights do not exhaust the feminist question because representation and public participation remain unequal even after suffrage. (PDF pp.91-93)
- FACT: Firestone's account gives biology a very strong explanatory role, but that is one radical position, not a universal feminist doctrine. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: Socialist feminism widens explanation but risks submerging specifically gendered experiences inside general anti-capitalist politics unless carefully handled. (inferred from PDF pp.89-90)
- ANALYSIS: The enduring debate is whether patriarchy is best seen as a legal exclusion, a sexual power system, or a system intertwined with class and labour.
- WRONG: Treating any one school as "the" feminist position produces caricature and weak answers.

8. Comparative matrix

Semantic table split - Issue

- **Issue**: Main problem
- **Liberal feminism**: FACT: Formal exclusion and discriminatory barriers. (PDF p.88)
- **Radical feminism**: FACT: Patriarchal sexual power and subordination. (PDF p.89)
- **Socialist feminism**: FACT: Combined effect of patriarchy and capitalism. (PDF pp.89-90)
- **Issue**: Key thinkers in Gauba
- **Liberal feminism**: FACT: Wollstonecraft, Mill. (PDF p.88)
- **Radical feminism**: FACT: Firestone, Millett. (PDF p.89)
- **Socialist feminism**: FACT: Rowbotham. (PDF pp.89-90)
- **Issue**: View of equality
- **Liberal feminism**: FACT: Equal opportunity and equal rights. (PDF p.88)
- **Radical feminism**: FACT: Deep restructuring of sex-power relations. (PDF p.89)

- **Socialist feminism:** FACT: Equality requires transforming labour, family and class relations. (PDF pp.89-90)
- **Issue:** Main analytical lens
- **Liberal feminism:** FACT: Law, education, profession, representation. (PDF p.88)
- **Radical feminism:** FACT: Reproduction, ideology, domination. (PDF p.89)
- **Socialist feminism:** FACT: Wage labour, domestic labour, history of oppression. (PDF pp.89-90)
- **Issue:** Major risk in exam answers
- **Liberal feminism:** WRONG: Reducing feminism to legal reform alone.
- **Radical feminism:** WRONG: Generalizing Firestone's biological emphasis to all feminism.
- **Socialist feminism:** WRONG: Collapsing gender into class and losing feminist specificity.

9. Application without current-affairs dependence

- ANALYSIS: If asked why equal voting rights did not automatically create equal political power, use Gauba's move from citizenship-in-law to actual representation.
- ANALYSIS: If asked whether social roles are natural, use sex/gender and natural/conventional inequality to show why many hierarchies are alterable.
- ANALYSIS: If asked to compare feminist schools, organize the answer by obstacle identified: law, patriarchy or capitalism-plus-patriarchy.
- ANALYSIS: A timeless example is the difference between biological maternity and the culturally enforced idea that only women should bear domestic-care burdens.

10. UPSC answer-engine prompts

- ANALYSIS: **Prompt 1:** Distinguish sex from gender and explain why the distinction matters politically.
- ANALYSIS: **Prompt 2:** Why is patriarchy a political category and not merely a family arrangement?
- ANALYSIS: **Prompt 3:** Compare liberal, radical and socialist feminism with one thinker each.
- ANALYSIS: **Prompt 4:** Why is formal citizenship insufficient from a feminist standpoint?
- ANALYSIS: **Mini spine:** define patriarchy -> sex/gender distinction -> one historical rights thinker -> three schools -> dated-data caution -> conclusion on justice.

11. Cross-links and exclusions

- FACT: Foundation companion: Political-Theory/basic/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md.
- FACT: Use Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md for the cross-topic matrix on ideology, power and justice.
- FACT: Use Political-Theory/README.md for the mapped continuities toward state, power, citizenship and justice.
- FACT: For cross-syllabus reinforcement, see
Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Gender-Discrimination.md and
Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Political-Ideologies.md.
- FACT: For constitutional-rights application, use Polity/advanced/07_Fundamental-Rights.md.
- FACT: Topic-map continuities especially point toward
Political-Theory/advanced/13_Diverse-Perspectives-on-the-State.md (feminist state),
Political-Theory/advanced/15_Power-Authority-and-Legitimacy.md (gendered power),
Political-Theory/advanced/16_Citizenship-and-Its-Critiques.md (feminist citizenship) and
Political-Theory/advanced/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md (feminist justice).
- WRONG: Do not turn this into a current-data note; the assigned task is political theory, not present-day gender indicators.

12. Factual-risk checks

- WRONG: Gauba's 1980 UN statistic on women's work, income and property is a dated historical citation and must not be presented as current fact. (PDF p.86)
- WRONG: The sentence that the condition remained unchanged "today" is itself book-period framing and must not be repeated as a present-day claim. (PDF p.86)
- WRONG: Representation percentages for Western Europe, the UK, the US and Scandinavian legislatures are late-twentieth-century illustrations, not current figures. (PDF pp.91-92)
- WRONG: Firestone's biology-centred account is a radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)
- WRONG: The 1995 UNDP GDI/GEM references are historical illustrations inside a 2009 text and should be labelled accordingly if used. (PDF pp.92-93)

13. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.84-93.
- FACT: Key anchors: feminism, patriarchy and sex/gender distinction (PDF pp.84-86); socialization and rights history (PDF pp.87-88); liberal/radical/socialist feminism (PDF pp.88-90); citizenship and representation discussion (PDF pp.90-93).
- ANALYSIS: Tags: #PoliticalTheory #Advanced #Feminism #Patriarchy #GenderJustice #Citizenship #Representation.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

ONE-PAGE CONCEPT GRID

Concept / thinker	Exam-ready formulation
Feminism	concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
Patriarchy	literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
Sex	biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
Gender	culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
Gender inequality	a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
Feminist theory	advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
Sex vs gender	sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.
Natural inequality vs conventional inequality	Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.
Legal equality vs substantive equality	early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
Equal treatment vs compensatory support	Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.
Mary Wollstonecraft	argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
J.S. Mill	argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.

CORE REVISION SPINE

- Key anchors: feminism, patriarchy, sex-gender distinction (PDF pp.84-86); socialization and inequality (PDF pp.86-87); Wollstonecraft, Mill and three streams of feminism (PDF pp.88-90).
- Objection: if gender is entirely performative/socially constructed (Butler), feminism loses a stable category of "woman" around which to organise and to claim rights. Reply: many feminist theorists respond that political claims can be built on provisionally, strategically stabilised categories even while accepting the category is historically constructed ("strategic essentialism"); legal sex-discrimination categories function pragmatically regardless of deeper philosophical instability. Present as a live, contested debate - not a settled result.
- "Discuss/Examine feminism as a critique of patriarchy" -> needs both diagnosis (what patriarchy is, how gender is produced) and the feminist reply; do not describe patriarchy without the feminist response.
- Thesis (1-2 lines): feminism protests patriarchal subordination via the sex/gender distinction; formal legal equality alone is insufficient.
- Gauba treats feminism as a protest against the inferior status assigned to women by patriarchy, not as a denial that biological differences exist. (PDF pp.84-86)
- The sex-gender distinction is central for answering why inequality can be socially constructed even when biological difference is real. (PDF pp.84-86)
- The three streams of feminism provide a compact framework for PSIR and GS-II answers on equality, citizenship and justice. (PDF pp.88-90)

- Feminism: concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex. (PDF p.84)
- Gender: culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men. (PDF pp.84-85)
- Gender inequality: a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change. (PDF p.86)
- Gauba starts by defining feminism as resistance to unjust female subordination produced by patriarchy. (PDF p.84)
- He then distinguishes sex from gender so that biological difference is separated from socially assigned inferiority. (PDF pp.84-86)

HIGH-RISK TRAPS

- Trap repair: Sex and gender mean the same thing. -> Gauba makes the distinction foundational: sex is biological, gender is cultural. (PDF pp.84-86)
- Trap repair: All feminism says women are biologically determined. -> Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)
- Trap repair: If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no further issue. -> Gauba shows later feminism asking about representation, social status and unequal participation in public power. (PDF pp.91-93)
- Trap repair: Old statistics in the book can be quoted as present reality. -> The 1980 UN figure and book-era representation data are historical and must not be presented as current fact. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)

ANSWER SPINE

1. Define the exact doctrine or controversy in the question.
2. State a qualified thesis before narration begins.
3. Reconstruct premises, mechanism and conclusion.
4. Add named thinkers and one precise distinction.
5. Present the strongest objection, reply and residual limitation.
6. End with a graded verdict tied to the directive.